

The Ferdinand Times

VOL. 1 — SUNDAY, OCTOBER 4, 2026 — MEXICO CITY — AS OF 5:45 A.M.

YOUR DAY

Sunday is Sleep-only; weekday skeleton returns Monday

Overnight, just-a-clipper-engine PR checks went red on docs work. Hetzner's final warning is still open. La Casa (Tue) and the Oct 9 SpaceXAI / Buildathon stack are still off the calendar. Rain showers likely today.



Ferdinand, Google Calendar today shows only Sleep—the usual weekend blank, with no News/Swim/Miami/Discovery blocks until Monday morning. Overnight GitHub mail is noisy: pull-request checks on feraranas/just-a-clipper-engine failed repeatedly, including docs PRs that add or narrow an architecture-diagram skill, plus a Codex review note that usage limits for code reviews were hit.

Hetzner's Final Payment Warning from September 25 is still sitting in Inbox. Looking ahead, ¿La IA nos matará a todos? at La Casa de Satoshi on Tuesday, October 6, 6:00–9:00 p.m. remains Luma-approved and still missing from Google Calendar—it overlaps Discovery. Friday, October 9, still stacks a pending Grok Bot CDMX × SpaceXAI morning (10:00 a.m.–1:00 p.m., host approval not in) with an already-approved Reap × AIBM Agentic Buildathon that evening (5:00–9:00 p.m., Sandbox Hub)—both off calendar against the weekday skeleton. An Apple SuperGrok renewal notice also points at around October 9; treat it as FYI only. Saturday's GDG Probabilidad session is past.

WEATHER

~20° / ~15° HIGH / LOW

Cool and damp at compile (~15°C, light rain shower, ~86% humidity, heavy cloud). Showers likely through the day; MET Norway shows heavier rain periods. High near 20°C. Indoor plans help if you go out for music tonight.

MON	Patchy rain nearby	~22 / ~15
TUE	Still showery (La Casa eve)	~22 / ~15
WED	Rain eases; totals lower	~21 / ~15

NEEDS A LOOK

GITHUB ACTION
just-a-clipper-engine PR checks failing overnight. Docs / architecture-diagram skill PRs; verify job red.

HETZNER BILLING ACTION
Final warning; services still marked blocked. Sep 25 PDF still open.

LUMA / LA CASA DE SATOSHI ACTION
AI-risk talk – still approved, still off calendar. Tue Oct 6, 6–9 p.m.; vs Discovery.

LUMA / SPACEXAI ACTION
Grok Bot CDMX – Oct 9 morning pending. 10:00 a.m.–1:00 p.m.; host approval not in yet.

REAP LATAM / LUMA FYI
Agentic Buildathon spot approved. Fri Oct 9, 5–9 p.m., Sandbox Hub CDMX.

APPLE FYI
SuperGrok renewal around Oct 9. Notice only.

TODAY

–	Weekend blank	CALENDAR
	Sleep only; no weekday skeleton	

THIS WEEK

- MON OCT 5** – Weekday skeleton resumes: News / Swim / Miami / Discovery / Journaling.
TUE OCT 6 – ¿La IA nos matará a todos? 6:00–9:00 p.m.; La Casa de Satoshi; approved (not on calendar; vs Discovery).
WED OCT 7 – Checkpoint day 10:00 p.m.–midnight; overlaps Journaling.
FRI OCT 9 – Grok Bot CDMX con SpaceXAI, 10:00 a.m.–1:00 p.m.; pending approval.
FRI OCT 9 – Reap x AIBM Agentic Buildathon, 5:00–9:00 p.m.; Sandbox Hub CDMX; registration approved.

TONIGHT

Optional culture – Guillotina at Lunario 7:00 p.m., or OFCM / Vivaldi at Sala Silvestre Revueltas 6:00 p.m.; rain odds nontrivial – see On the Town.

DUE

Hetzner final warning / services blocked (still open).

INBOX

BYTEBYTEGO

How SSH Works

FROM BYTEBYTEGO NEWSLETTER · EP228

TCP handshake to host-key check to session keys computed on each side—then public-key auth without the private key ever leaving your machine. Same issue: AI efficiency tricks, agent anatomy, and evals.

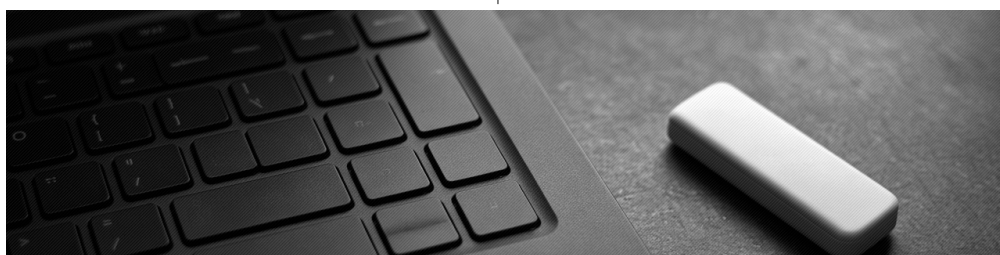
Secure shell is a method to access a remote machine securely over an unsecured network. It starts with a TCP connection from the SSH client to the remote machine (SSH server).

Both the machines exchange the SSH versions and negotiate crypto algorithms, and each side runs a key exchange protocol. The SSH server sends the public key and a signature, which the client machine verifies. That host key is then checked against the known_hosts file.

Both the machines then derive session keys on their end and do not share them over the network. Same keys, computed separately, never put on the wire. Then the SSH client starts authentication by sending the public key for login.

The SSH server matches the public key in the authorized_keys, and the SSH client also signs the auth request with the private key and sends the digital signature to the SSH server.

The private key never leaves your machine. The server will verify the signature with the client public key. This completes the SSH authentication, and now the session is open for communication.



EDITOR'S SUMMARY: EP228 is a clean SSH diagram in prose: version/crypto negotiation, host-key verify against known_hosts, independently derived session keys, then public-key login with signatures so the private key stays local. Same Saturday issue also packs six serving tricks (streaming, quantization, continuous batching, prefix caching, paged KV, speculative decoding), a five-part agent anatomy (brain, planning, tools, memory, loop—plus guardrails), and a three-step eval recipe (task → data → grader). Sidebar: live AI Evals in Practice course with Manjeet Singh starts October 7.

SYSTEM DESIGN ONE

How Vector Database Search Billions of Vectors in Milliseconds

BY AVANI CHASKAR · ISSUE #186

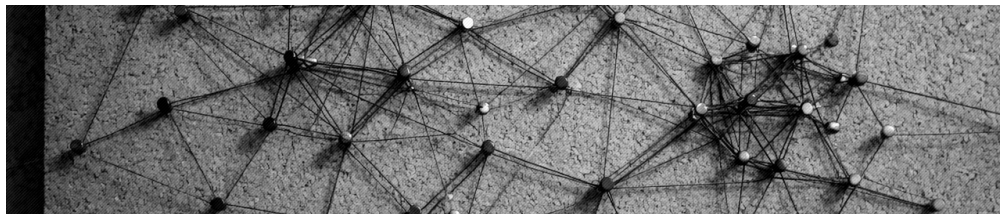
Shazam-scale similarity in under 50 ms needs approximate nearest neighbor—not a full scan. HNSW builds layered graph shortcuts; knobs are M, efConstruction, and efSearch.

Imagine you're building Shazam. A user hums a 10-second song clip...Your system has 100 million songs. Your job is simple: find the most similar songs in less than 50 milliseconds.

Here's the obvious solution: compare the user's song with each song in the database. Yet this does NOT work at scale.

When you search documents in a RAG system, find similar images, or generate recommendations, the system is doing the same thing: Find the most similar items in a massive collection. This is where Hierarchical Navigable Small World (HNSW) comes in...

The Idea: Search Only What Matters – Instead of comparing against every item, build shortcuts that lead you close to the answer.



EDITOR'S SUMMARY: Chaskar frames ANN vs exact search with a Shazam clock: under 50 ms against ~100 million items. HNSW stacks graph layers—every item on the bottom, long-range shortcuts higher up—so queries hop toward neighbors instead of scanning the whole set. Three knobs dominate behavior: M (graph degree), efConstruction (build-time candidate list), and efSearch (query-time list). Memory cost is high; production systems often pair HNSW with SQ8 or product quantization. Same pattern shows up in RAG retrieval, image search, and recommendations. Fresh Sunday morning clip; pairs with yesterday's S3 Vectors / decision-model infra reading without repeating it.

INBOX

TLDR DESIGN

Instagram Video Assistant, Firefox 157 redesign, leaner Apple

FROM TLDR DESIGN

*Edits gets a metrics-aware AI coach; Firefox ships a full visual refresh with Compact Mode back; Ternus pushes fewer layers and more frequent releases.***INSTAGRAM ROLLS OUT AN AI VIDEO ASSISTANT FOR CREATORS**

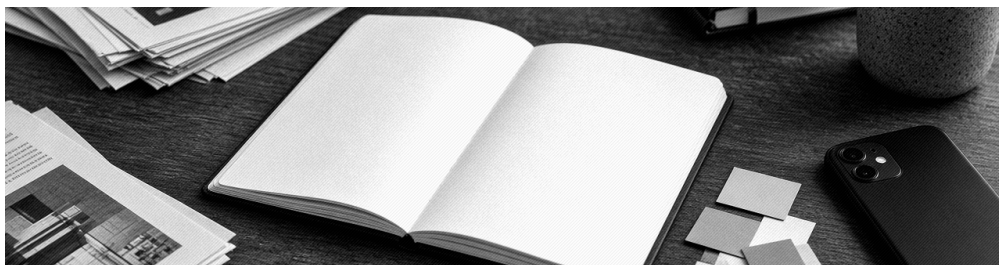
Instagram is rolling out an AI video assistant in Edits, its CapCut competitor, that gives creators personalized feedback instead of generic advice. The assistant combines account metrics like views and video retention with comments and trends to spot performance patterns, while leaving creative calls to creators. Usage is capped, with more available through a Meta One subscription.

THE NEW FIREFOX DESIGN: MORE MODERN, MORE FLEXIBLE, STILL FIREFOX

Mozilla is rolling out the Firefox 157 redesign to all desktop and mobile users, refreshing colors, icons, and themes across the browser without hurting performance. The update adds flexibility through a returning Compact Mode, a theme picker with new themes and wallpapers, and a customizable New Tab page with pinned shortcuts. Firefox remains independent and open source, with built-in privacy protections and user controls, including over AI features.

JOHN TERNUS HAS BIG PLANS TO MAKE APPLE 'LEANER' AND RELEASE MORE PRODUCTS

Apple CEO John Ternus reportedly wants a leaner organization focused on engineering, with fewer management layers and more frequent product releases.



EDITOR'S SUMMARY: Friday's Design book is a product-surface triple: Instagram Edits' assistant reads retention and comments then stops short of taking creative control; Firefox 157 is a skin-and-layout refresh that brings Compact Mode back and keeps AI toggles user-owned; Ternus's "leaner Apple" brief is fewer program-manager layers and a less seasonal ship cadence. Secondary clips worth skimming: products that outgrow their original UI floor plan, and a practical "de-slopify" ladder for AI-generated design comps. Primary newspaper clip is Firefox 157 + the Instagram assistant—useful next to today's film/music night options.

THE TOWN

RECOMMENDED

Firefox 157 redesign – desktop and mobile

Mozilla's Firefox 157 refresh is rolling to everyone: new colors and icons, Compact Mode returned, theme picker with wallpapers, and a New Tab you can pin. Performance claim is that the visual pass does not slow the browser, and AI features stay behind user controls rather than a forced default.

ByteByteGo AI Evals in Practice – starts Wed Oct 7

The same SSH issue flags a live course with Manjeet Singh (Salesforce) on eval design for agents: LLM-as-judge, red-teaming, RAG/tool checks, and wiring evals into CI/CD. Useful if overnight clipper red checks made "how do we know this works?" feel less abstract.

ON THE TOWN

**Guillotina / Rock Mata Pop – Sun Oct 4, 7:00 p.m., Lunario**

Local rock/pop bill at the Lunario del Auditorio Nacional tonight. Indoor room, roughly 90 minutes, all-ages listing. Easy Sunday option if you want volume without stacking midweek Luma nights.

OFCM + Cuarteto Sonarte – Sun Oct 4, 6:00 p.m., Sala Silvestre Revueltas

Mexico City Philharmonic with Cuarteto Sonarte: Vivaldi's Four Seasons plus a mandolin concerto arranged for three guitars and orchestra. Earlier than Guillotina if you want the classical lane; also indoor on a shower day. Looking ahead: Pablo Alborán at Auditorio Nacional Thu–Fri Oct 8–9, and an Interstellar film-concert with live Zimmer score Fri Oct 9 at Teatro Xola Julio Prieto—same Friday as the SpaceXAI / Buildathon stack.

PUZZLES



Sunday. Sleep only.

Red checks. Rain on the glass.

Umbrella up. Notes still blank.

MINI CROSSWORD

1	2	3	4	5
6				
7				
8				
9				

ACROSS

1 Quiet center of a Sleep-only Sunday

6 Overnight CI failure still glowing as an __

7 What not to do to a pending Luma host approval

8 Sticky pine product – or unfinished-calendar glue

9 Wet-week weather __ into midweek showers

DOWN

1 Same as 1-Across (word-square twin)

2 Same as 6-Across

3 Same as 7-Across

4 Same as 8-Across

5 Same as 9-Across

HEART · EMBER · ABUSE · RESIN · TREND

DEAR TIMES

Calendar is Sleep-only, CI is red, Tuesday’s talk still isn’t on the calendar –what do I fix first?

Dear Times, Sunday shows only Sleep. Overnight mail says just-a-clipper-engine PR checks failed again. Hetzner’s final warning is still open. La Casa is Tuesday at 6:00 and still not on Google Calendar. Friday stacks a pending SpaceXAI morning with an approved Buildathon. It’s raining. Do I debug CI, pay Hetzner, or just put Tuesday on the calendar?

– Damp Sunday in Mexico City

Dear Damp Sunday, Put La Casa on the calendar this morning so Tuesday’s Discovery block is an honest conflict, not a surprise. Then open the Hetzner thread in daylight—not after a concert. Clipper CI can wait until you’re at a keyboard with the failing verify logs; red overnight mail is a breadcrumb, not an emergency alarm. Leave SpaceXAI pending until host approval lands, and keep the Buildathon evening marked once you place it. If you go out tonight, Guillotina at 7:00 or OFCM at 6:00 are both indoor; umbrella either way.

– The Times

JUMBLE

Unscramble each word. Circled answer boxes spell the bonus. What Hetzner’s Final Payment Warning still is in Inbox (4 letters).

THOS

□○□□

PEELS

□□□□○

YEKS

□○□□

NARI

□□□○

HOST SLEEP KEYS RAIN · OPEN

WANTED

One Google Calendar entry for an already-approved Tuesday night.

Applicants must place ¿La IA nos matará a todos? (6:00–9:00 p.m.) on the primary calendar before Discovery wins by default. Mail-only RSVPs will be returned unread.

Host approval for Grok Bot CDMX on SpaceXAI (Fri Oct 9, 10:00 a.m.–1:00 p.m.).

Evening Buildathon ticket holders (5:00–9:00 p.m., Sandbox Hub) reminded that morning pending ≠ evening approved.

FOR SALE

Slightly damp Sunday with optional rock or Vivaldi.

Conditioned by light rain showers and a Sleep-only calendar. Buyer chooses Lunario 7:00 or Sala Silvestre Revueltas 6:00. Umbrella not included but strongly implied.

Spare SSH mental model (conceptual).

Includes known_hosts check, session keys that never ride the wire, and a reminder that private keys stay home. Inspired by ByteByteGo EP228. Does not clear a Hetzner warning.

NOTICES

Department of Red Checks

feraranas/just-a-clipper-engine verify jobs failed overnight on docs / architecture-diagram skill PRs. Citizens holding Codex review-limit notices should treat them as usage FYI, not a second outage.

Municipal weather desk

~15°C and showery at compile; high near 20°C; rain continues Mon–Wed with totals easing later. Guillotina and OFCM are indoor. This is weather, not a seat assignment.